

Multiple Choice

1. **Answer:** A

Options: A) political and military history.; B) philosophy and religion.; C) trade and economics.; D) astronomy and mathematics.

Note: The correct answer is justified because the Maya's written records predominantly focused on documenting their political hierarchies, military conquests, and royal lineages, in contrast to Mesopotamian writings, which often emphasized economic transactions and administrative details.

2. **Answer:** D

Options: A) unilineal evolution.; B) environmental uniformitarianism.; C) multicultural adaptation.; D) multilinear evolution.

Note: Multilinear evolution is the concept that cultures develop and adapt in diverse ways over time based on their unique environmental contexts, rather than following a single linear path.

3. **Answer:** A

Options: A) maize, beans, and squash; B) maize, lentils, and wheat; C) rice, beans, and squash; D) yams, maize, and millet

Note: Maize, beans, and squash, often referred to as the "Three Sisters," form a complementary agricultural triad that provided essential nutrients and supported the agricultural practices of indigenous New World civilizations, making them foundational to their subsistence.

4. **Answer:** A

Options: A) religious iconography; B) large armies; C) agricultural surpluses; D) all of the above

Note: The unifying element of Olmec culture was religious iconography, as it played a central role in their art, architecture, and social practices, reflecting their beliefs and values across various aspects of their civilization.

5. **Answer:** D

Options: A) diastema.; B) cranium.; C) maxilla.; D) sagittal crest.

Note: The sagittal crest is a bony ridge that runs along the top of the skull in certain hominins, including *Australopithecus robustus*, providing a surface for the attachment of strong jaw muscles, which is indicative of their dietary adaptations.

True / False

6. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The statement is false because the Yangshao culture is primarily associated with the domestication of millet and not wheat, rice, or peas.

7. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Primatology is actually the study of primates, including their behavior, biology, and evolution, rather than the study of the Earth's layers and geological formations, which falls under geology.

8. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Pompeii's preservation was primarily due to the volcanic ash and pumice from the eruption of Mount Vesuvius in 79 AD, not avalanches or seawater.

9. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Capacocha was actually an Incan ritual involving the sacrifice of children, not a practice of feasting on the hearts of slain enemies.

10. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The statement is false because historical records indicate that the population of ancient Egypt was not solely composed of farmers, as there were also artisans, laborers, and a ruling class in addition to the agricultural population.

Long Form Response

11. **Answer:** The key differences between Aurignacian and Mousterian technologies lie in their advancements in tool design and the implications for early human life. Aurignacian technology is characterized by the production of long, narrow blades that provided a greater usable surface area compared to the more robust, flake-based tools of the Mousterian period. This advancement allowed early humans to create more efficient cutting tools, which improved their ability to process food and other materials. The increased versatility and effectiveness of Aurignacian tools likely contributed to a more complex social structure and enhanced survival strategies among early modern humans. Overall, the transition from Mousterian to Aurignacian technology marks a significant step in the evolution of human ingenuity and adaptability.

Note: The answer correctly identifies that the Aurignacian technology's development of long, narrow blades represents a significant advancement over the Mousterian's flake-based tools, leading to greater efficiency in processing resources essential for early human survival.

12. **Answer:** The appearance of early human ancestors during the final 3 seconds of the film is significant because it highlights the brief yet impactful moment in the vast timeline of the universe's history. This timing emphasizes the idea that, despite the immense scale of cosmic events spanning billions of years, human existence is a

relatively recent development. The film suggests that humanity's emergence is crucial because it marks the beginning of conscious thought and the ability to reflect on our place in the universe. This moment invites viewers to consider both the fragility and the importance of human life in the grand scheme of history.

Note: correct because it underscores the contrast between the vastness of the universe's timeline and the recent emergence of human ancestors, emphasizing the significance of human consciousness and reflection in shaping our understanding of existence.